VARAD VIJAY KHOPKAR

Cybersecurity | Information Security | Security Operations

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PROFILE

Cybersecurity professional with hands-on experience in enterprise security operations and security engineering in endpoint, network, email, cloud and data security. I have experience in various security monitoring, alert investigation, threat detection, incident response, root cause analysis, remediation, and tuning security controls to enhance the level of security detection. Worked with a variety of security solution vendors including CrowdStrike Falcon, Microsoft Defender, Cisco Secure Email, Fortinet, Netskope CASB, Automox and DLP. I also have hands-on experience with KQL, Python, Bash, PowerShell, and the MITRE ATT&CK framework; have used security telemetry from several sources to investigate suspicious activity, minimize false positives and strengthen overall security controls.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security Operations & Incident Response:
Security Monitoring • Alert Triage • Incident Response • Incident Investigation • Threat Detection • Threat Hunting • IOC Analysis • Threat Intelligence • Root Cause Analysis • Incident Containment & Remediation • Security Event Analysis • Incident Documentation • Security Reporting

Security Engineering & Detection:
Detection Engineering • Detection Logic • Detection Tuning • Security Control Validation • Security Control Optimization • Security Policy Enforcement • Endpoint Security • Network Security • Cloud Security • Email Security • Data Loss Prevention (DLP)

Security Platforms & Tools:
CrowdStrike Falcon • Microsoft Defender for Endpoint • Microsoft 365 Security • Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD) • Cisco Secure Email (ESA) • Cisco Secure Email Management Appliance (SMA) • Cisco IronPort • Netskope CASB • FortiGate • FortiManager • FortiAnalyzer • Automox

Identity & Cloud Security:
Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD) • Microsoft 365 Security • MFA • Conditional Access • Cloud Security • Netskope CASB

Network & Infrastructure Security:
Network Traffic Analysis • Firewall Policy Management • VPN • NAT • Network Segmentation • Windows • Linux • TCP/IP • DNS

Security Monitoring & Querying:
SIEM Concepts • KQL (Working Knowledge) • SPL / SIEM Query Concepts (Familiarity) • SOAR Concepts • Security Event Correlation

Threat Intelligence & Security Tools:
VirusTotal • AlienVault OTX • ThreatFox • URLScan.io • Shodan • Maltego • Wireshark • Nmap • Burp Suite • OWASP ZAP • Kali Linux

Vulnerability, Risk & Compliance:
Vulnerability Management • Vulnerability Assessment • Vulnerability Intelligence • CVE Analysis • CVSS-Based Prioritization • Risk Assessment • Risk Impact Evaluation • Patch Management • Secure Configuration • Security Compliance • Security Governance • Control Testing • Access Governance • Compliance Monitoring

Programming & Automation:
Python • Bash • PowerShell (Basic) • Flask • REST APIs • Pandas • Git • GitHub • Security Automation

Frameworks & Methodologies:
MITRE ATT&CK • Cyber Kill Chain • Incident Response Lifecycle • CVE Analysis • Risk Assessment • Secure Configuration • Patch Management

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Technology (B. Tech) in Computer Science & Engineering (Cyber Security Specialization) **2022-2026**
Ajeenkya DY Patil University, Pune, India | Graduate Engineer.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Cyber Security Engineer Intern - Magic Software Enterprises India Pvt. Ltd. **10/2025 - Present**

- Installed, configured, managed enterprise endpoints with Administered CrowdStrike Falcon, including endpoint sensor deployment and configuration, endpoint host management, and endpoint sensor upgrades on servers and workstations.
- Analysed and responded to endpoint security alerts by reviewing CrowdStrike EDR telemetry, including Process behaviour, Command-line activity, Execution context, Indicators of Attack (IOAs) and Endpoint activity.
- Tuned CrowdStrike detection, taking a look at detection behaviour and applying regex-based exclusions for IOA/IOCs to minimise false positive detection and ensure endpoint protection.
- Managed and optimized CrowdStrike prevention and security policies, including validating behaviour and making adjustments to policies as a result of investigations and operational requirements.
- Conducted endpoint incident response and threat hunting activities via CrowdStrike telemetry and security intelligence, including endpoint root cause analysis, containment, remediation and validation of impacted endpoints.
- Managed and optimized Cisco Secure Email (ESA/SMA) and Microsoft 365 Security to enhance phishing, malware, spam, and Business Email Compromise (BEC) defences.
- Analysed email headers for phishing and suspicious email activity; validated emails with SPF, DKIM, DMARC to detect and prevent email-based attacks.
- Powered identity and access security with authentication, access and security-policy management, using Microsoft Entra ID and Microsoft 365 security controls.
- Actively managed web and cloud security controls with Netskope CASB, applied organization policies, monitored user activity, and investigated issues related to application access and security policies.
- Designed and implemented DLP policies and controls that protect sensitive organizational data, minimize risks to data exfiltration and meet security and compliance needs.

- Set up and manage FortiGate, FortiManager and FortiAnalyzer to implement network security policies, enhance security visibility, and analyzed network-based threats such as password sprays.
- Integrate endpoint, email, cloud and network telemetry from various security platforms to look for anomalous activity, find attack patterns and enhance detection capability.
- Achieve better endpoint compliance and less security exposure with Managed vulnerability remediation and OS-specific patch management policies using Automox.
- Triage, prioritize, investigate, escalate, and document relevant stakeholders for managed cybersecurity incidents and service requests via Jira Service Management.
- Developed and maintained security documentation, investigation results, operational bulletins, and security reports for incident, risk, remediation efforts and security-control effectiveness.

Cyber Security Analyst Intern - adoSolve InfoTech Pvt. Ltd **06/2024 - 03/2025**

- Processed and reviewed security logs, network traffic, endpoint telemetry, and security events for any indications of unusual activity, Indicators of Compromise (IOCs) and possible suspicious activity in order to detect threats and respond to them.
- Evaluated and resolved security incidents, confirmed true and false positives and reviewed evidence to escalate incidents using incident handling processes.
- Encouraged the use of endpoint, network, and log telemetry in investigations to understand what is happening and detect unusual activity to aid in security incident investigations.
- Perform Vulnerability, CVE and Risk Impact Assessments to facilitate vulnerability remediation prioritization and mitigate security exposure.
- Included with the supported IOCs, threat intelligence and threat-hunting capabilities during security investigations to detect potentially malicious activity and increase visibility.
- Helped with endpoint deployment, security monitoring, detection analysis, and validation of endpoint protection controls for the operational roll-out of CrowdStrike Falcon.
- Established and supported Security SOPs, Incident Response playbooks, Investigation documentation, and operational procedures to ensure consistency in security operations.
- Utilized the MITRE concepts, detection logic, alert optimization, and security-event analysis to assist with the day-to-day security operations.

PROJECTS

VulnaBoard | Vulnerability Intelligence Platform
Tech Stack: Python • Flask • SQLite • Pandas • NVD API • HTML/CSS
GitHub: github.com/Varad-Khopkar/VulnaBoard

- Developed a Python/Flask-based vulnerability intelligence platform to automate the collection, processing, analysis, prioritization, and visualization of CVE data from the National Vulnerability Database (NVD).
- Engineered an automated vulnerability-data ingestion pipeline to retrieve NVD feeds, normalize vulnerability data, maintain historical records, and support continuous vulnerability monitoring and analysis.
- Implemented CVSS-based vulnerability prioritization, automatically identifying and tracking high-risk vulnerabilities with severity scores of 9.0 and above.
- Designed an interactive dashboard to visualize vulnerability trends, severity metrics, historical CVE data, and vulnerability details, improving visibility into emerging security risks and remediation priorities.
- Built the platform with a modular architecture supporting future integration with threat intelligence feeds, asset inventories, and enterprise vulnerability-management workflows.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Fortinet Certified Cybersecurity Associate (FCCA) Mar 2024
- Fortinet Certified Fundamentals in Cybersecurity (FCF) Feb 2024
- Ethical Hacking Essentials - EC-Council (EHE) Feb 2024

LEADERSHIP

Student Placement Head - Ajeenkya DY Patil University (2025-26)
Led placement coordination initiatives, facilitating communication between students, recruiters, and university stakeholders while supporting campus recruitment activities.

Founding President — Cyber Alchemists Club, ADYPU (2023 – 2026)
Founded and led a cybersecurity-focused student community, organizing technical workshops, awareness programs, and industry engagement initiatives.

Founding Secretary — Rotaract Club of ADYPU, RID 3131 (2024 – 2026)
Co-founded and scaled a university-level organization, leading community service, professional development, and leadership initiatives.

General Secretary — HashTech 2023-24
Directed operations and cross-functional coordination for a large-scale university technical and cultural event involving multiple teams and stakeholders.